

Forbidden Romance

We don't choose who we fall in love with and some romances happen against all probability and are unsupported even by friends and family. How did you meet? How did you come to be in love? What is the very best thing about the other?



Being in love in secret is hard and often heartbreaking. Why are you not allowed to be together? Who or what is stopping you? How could this be resolved?

Forbidden Romance

Rivals

Your characters have some sort of rivalry between them, what is it? In what ways has your rivalry pushed each other towards greatness? What caused/inspired your rivalry? What do you respect most about the other?



What are the destructive aspects of this rivalry? What is the worst thing you have done in your attempt to outperform the other? How could one of you finally win and what would the consequences be?

Rivals

Inseparable Siblings

You have been inseparable since day one. Whatever may come, you'll always be each other's first best friend, and nothing can sever that bond. How did your childhood mold you into a team? In what ways are you similar to one another? What have you forgiven each other for?



No one can get on your nerves like those closest to you. You love your sibling, but that doesn't mean your relationship is entirely without turbulence. Why do you still think the other person needs to grow up? How do you push each other's buttons on purpose? What was your latest conflict about? Why wasn't it resolved?

Inseparable Siblings

Estranged Siblings

There was a time when your relationship was, if not good, at least neutral. All hope is not lost; perhaps you can find your way back. How do you remember the best part(s) of your relationship? Why do you want to repair your relationship? What would it take for you to forgive your sibling?



You two are always at each other's throats; family events are a nightmare. Being expected to not only love, but also like each other, only turns hatred into bitterness. Why do you blame each other for your relationship? In what ways are you irreconcilably different? What old grudges do you still hold against each other?

Estranged Siblings

Lovers

You mean the world to each other. When and how did you meet? How long have you been together? Why is the other your soul-mate?



You risk co-dependency; you isolate each other. In what ways are your needs not being met in this relationship? When did you last cross a boundary with each other? Why would an ending thrust you into despair?

Lovers

Best Friends

How long have you been friends for? Where and how did you meet? What is the meaning of 'Best Friends' to each of you?



You know one another so well, in what ways does friendship become controlling or toxic? What was the worst argument you have ever had about? In what ways do you reinforce one another's bad behaviours?

Best Friends

Mentor and Protégé

How have you already caused each other to improve? What have you taught or learned from one another?



How do you adversely affect each other's independence? What are the aspects of this relationship that need to be resolved?

Mentor and Protégé

Parent and Child

This can be a biological relation or a symbolic one. How do you care for one another? What is the most important thing about your relationship?



Why do you think the other person ought to be more grateful? What bars you from understanding one another? When and how have you disappointed each other in the past?

Parent and Child

Long-Lost Siblings

Somehow you always knew that you had a sibling; describe how this manifested.



Time has changed both of you - how? What is the nature of the distance between you? How can you regain your relationship?

Long-Lost Siblings

Secret Admirers

Tell the player of the character you admire what is it that you admire about their character. The character, of course, does not know this.



There must be a reason why you have chosen not to reveal this admiration; what is it? At its most extreme, why are you afraid to reveal this secret?

Secret Admirers

Enemies Turned Allies

Adversity sometimes helps people come together. What is the story here? Why were you in opposition and how did you come together?



Are there some aspects of this antagonistic past you have not yet addressed? What still needs to be resolved or forgiven?

Enemies Turned Allies

Unlikely Allies

You may not have been adversaries, but there is something unusual about your friendship. In what ways were you different and how did you come together?



What happens when your alliance is no longer needed? Discuss the frictions in your relationship and what would be needed to protect it.

Unlikely Allies

Old Flames

In every love story there is a perfect time and place. What is your character's "We'll always have Paris" moment? Remember the best night of your time together.



There is a reason why this relationship did not persist. Talk about it and agree what went wrong and whether it could, or should, be rekindled?

Old Flames

Master and Servant

Rather than being a literal description of a relationship, this is a metaphor for an unequal power balance. What does this term mean to you, how did it manifest in positive ways?



What are the negative aspects of this imbalance. How do you take advantage of each other?

Master and Servant

Partners in Crime

This term can refer to youthful hijinx rather than real criminality; make up a story or two you can share. If you do want it to be criminal, consider the balance of the larp and keep it realistic.



You are headed or have travelled down a dark path together, discuss this. What had gone wrong. What is the downside of this relationship and now could it become something else?

Partners in Crime

One-time Enemies

What happened all those years ago that set you against one another? Why did (the aftermath of) that one moment have a positive influence on your life?



What is stopping you from letting go of the past? What would it take for all signs to be forgiven?

One-time Enemies

Childhood Friends

How old were you when you met? Find a shared memory. What is an inside joke you have that no one else gets?



In what way(s) are you growing apart?
How could that be mitigated?

Childhood Friends

Estranged Family Members

It is sad when family members fall out, but tell one another about the happy times.



Why did you fall out with one another? Why are you struggling to reconnect? What would it take for a reconciliation?

Estranged Family Members

Bitter Exes

You used to be good to (and for) each other. What happened? How does your antagonism for one another play out?



You bring out the worst in each other. Think about your behaviours and how these could be identified and worked on so that you could work towards some forgiveness.

Bitter Exes

Shared Addiction

You understand each others struggle in a way no one else can. What is the nature of the addiction. How did (or does) it manifest.



Talk about the ways that you enable each other but pivot from here into finding a way you can support one another's recovery.

Shared Addiction

Secret Siblings

Why can you never tell the world that you are related? Tell about a time you still managed to be together.



How does your secret put you at risk? What would it take to release you from the past?

Secret Siblings

Criminal Past

How was it that you met? Tell a tale of a time you got away with a crime. Try to keep the crime realistic, small scale rather than murder or espionage.



You will take each other down if one of you falls. Consider how to unpick this web of crime and find a way to find justice, or redemption.

Criminal Past

Teacher and Student

This phrase can be interpreted in different ways; what makes sense for your characters? What have you already learned from each other?



How will you react when the student surpasses the master? What is the benefit of this relationship beyond what you have taught or learned from one another? How can it become a friendship built on mutual respect?

Teacher and Student

Distant Relatives

Blood is thicker than water, find some family connection that binds you. What is this wedge and how can it be released?



There is implicit loyalty, yet family politics have driven a wedge between you. What is the nature of this wedge and how can it be released?

Distant Relatives

Co-workers

Strange to find a co-worker at Hope. Find some common ground or tell a story of your shared work place.



How do your work roles bleed into your relationship? How can a colleague become a friend? What does it take to build trust?

Co-workers

Leader and Follower

What does this term mean to you, how does it manifest in positive ways?



How might the leader be willing to sacrifice the follower? What would cause the follower to leave? With these in mind, what would it take to cement the relationship and remove any perceived imbalance?

Leader and Follower

Savior and Saved

This phrase can be interpreted in different ways; what makes sense for your characters?



Is there a debt to be repaid here? How can the imbalance in this relationship change into something mutual?

Savior and Saved

Frenemies

Agree on the positive aspects of your strange frenemy relationship. What do you like about one another?



**When have you gone too far in the past?
What would happen if you did again? What
would it take for you to be true friends?**

Frenemies

Neighbors

Strange to find someone who lives close at Hope. Find some common ground or tell a story of your shared community.



How far are you willing to go to keep the peace? How can you build true trust with someone you only vaguely know?

Neighbors

Comrades in Arms

This does not necessarily involve literal warfare, find a shared story either of adversity or victory.



Sometimes you need to lay down your arms in order to move forward. How do you stop each other from doing that? Find a way to strengthen the bond that you have that transcends the shared struggle.

Comrades in Arms

Healer and Patient

This phrase can be interpreted in different ways; what makes sense for your characters?



There is always a risk that something will go wrong. When was the last time that happened, and what did it look like? How do you change the nature of this relationship into something that will last?

Healer and Patient

Detective and Informant

This is not necessarily a literal detective, but it could be. One of you wants information from the other; what is this information? How was it that you met? Tell a tale of a time you helped one another out. Do you trust one another?



How do you put each other at risk? Is there anything about this relationship that is not transactional. How to you change the nature of this relationship so that it is built on a foundation of trust?

Detective and Informant

Hero and Sidekick

You are an unstoppable duo but one of you is slightly in the shadow of the other. Talk about this and explain why the relationship works for you both.



There is jealousy here, and possibly entitlement. Discuss the nature of this and consider ways it could change to become something more equal.

Hero and Sidekick

Roommates

Strange to find someone who lives with you at Hope. Find some common ground or tell a story of your shared household.



The little slights and pet peeves are adding up, there are things about the other person that are profoundly irritating and frustrating. What is the route to resolution here?

Roommates

Business Partners

You work together and have clearly been successful. Make some shared stories about your business successes.



Why would/could you usurp each other?
How is the business changing and what - if
not changed - will lead to you abandon-
ing one another? What is the nature of the
change that needs to be made?

Business Partners

Old Rivals

How has your rivalry settled down. What is the best thing about your old rival?



You may fall back into old patterns. What are these patterns and how can they manifest in the game? How can they be resolved?

Old Rivals

Adoptive Family

Some say that the family we choose is the most important kind of family. Discuss this choice and find some powerful bonds.



Why is the adoptive bond not enough for you? What do you need to consolidate the love you have for one another?

Adoptive Family

Pen Pals

Discuss the letters or messages you have sent to one another and how this long distance - written - relationship has grown.



You have not actually met prior to this.
How might you disappoint each other? How
can this disappointment be forgiven?

Pen Pals

Amicable Exes

You were in love once. How did you fall for each other? What broke you up?



What parts of yourselves are you giving up in order to maintain a positive relationship? Can it be rekindled? Should it be? Or can you find a way to stay friends?

Amicable Exes

Friendly Competitors

What does competition mean to you both?
Make some shared stories that are primarily about fun.



When do you become unfriendly? What are
the risks of you both being here? Is there a
way for you both to win?

Friendly Competitors

Rebel and Authority Figure

This phrase can be interpreted in different ways; what makes sense for your characters?



How are you purposefully misunderstanding each other? What are the steps towards mutual respect?

Rebel and Authority Figure

Idol and Fan

This phrase can be interpreted in different ways; what makes sense for your characters?



In what ways is this relationship unhealthy? What happens when the idol steps/falls off their pedestal? How can this relationship become something more mutual, or is there a way to replace toxicity with kindness and respect?

Idol and Fan

Found Family

Some say that the family we choose is the most important kind of family. Discuss this choice and find some powerful bonds.



Your fear of losing this family is preventing you from setting clear boundaries. What needs to be done to make this bond a healthy and sustainable one?

Found Family

Friends to Enemies

You were friends, once. What are your most treasured shared memories?



How/why did you fall out? What does the path to forgiveness look like?

Friends to Enemies

Opposites Attract

What is it that you see in one another?



This cannot end well; you are an explosion
waiting to happen. What could be the trig-
ger? How can this be defused?

Opposites Attract

Political Rivals

Find some grounds for mutual respect. You might disagree on politics but where do you agree?



You may corrupt one another. How might this play out? What is the reconciliation path?

Political Rivals

War Buddies

This does not necessarily involve literal warfare, find a shared story either of adversity or victory.



You excuse each other's behaviour because of your shared story. How can you call one another out and help each other to be a better person?

War Buddies

Survivors of Trauma

Please discuss your shared trauma and how you have supported one another in the past.



You are each other's triggers. Find a way to
or ways to help each other find a way to
break the cycle.

Survivors of Trauma

Survivors of a Tragedy

Please discuss your shared tragedy and talk about how you have supported one another in the past.



Which one of you suffered the most? In what ways are you not supporting one another? In what ways are you in competition? Find a different path towards healing.

Survivors of a Tragedy

Childhood Bully and Victim

One of you has an outlet for their insecurity, the other for their rage.



Your old wounds have festered. Plan an opportunity for working through your issues. Is forgiveness possible?

Childhood Bully and Victim

Terrible Secret

You are fiercely loyal, because betrayal isn't an option. What is this secret? (If the secret is too terrible, consider whether it should come out in open play. Check the lines and veils of co-players.)



You are being consumed by guilt, between you make a plan for shared redemption and forgiveness.

Terrible Secret

Tragic Secret

Your grief has bound you together. (If the secret is too tragic, consider whether it should come out in open play. Check the lines and veils of co-players.)



Your relationship is tainted by tragedy. How are you romanticising it? Is there a way to resolve the tragedy and the hurt that it has caused to you both? Can you let go?

Tragic Secret